MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 2, Episode 16 (Part One of Two)

"Take Cover"

Episode 2x16. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 2x16 (Part One of the Code Black two-parter).
Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Sunday, February 5, 2006 (Super Bowl XL), 5:31 AM through 6:22 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 41 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-2x15. Continued in 2x17.

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Sunday, February 5, 2006). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Sunday, February 5, 2006)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	27
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (39 weeks 2 days; in labor)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Russell Jeffries	Elxa's husband (car crash, subdural hematoma)	Apr 3, 1975	30
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	26
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	26
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	26
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	26
Dr. Bryce Kennerly	Surgical Intern	Jun 11, 1978	27
Nurse Kendra Wallace	Surgical Floor Nurse	May 30, 1980	25
Darius 'Dash' Duvall	Patient: Status 1A, day 86	Aug 8, 1971	34
Glenda Duvall	Dash's mother	Dec 12, 1947	58
Reginald 'Reggie' Plummer (new)	Patient: unexploded 37mm projectile in the left flank	Oct 30, 1967	38
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	OB/GYN and Fetal Surgeon	Mar 3, 1971	34
Dr. Abraham Lowery	Attending General Surgeon	Jan 9, 1947	59
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Danita Crews (new)	FDNY paramedic	Jun 26, 1978	27
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	46
Det. Sgt. Isaac Burrell (new)	NYPD Bomb Squad; ex-USMC EOD	Sep 14, 1961	44
Dr. Edwin Mabry (on-screen debut)	Chief of Anesthesiology	Jun 24, 1957	48
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Dr. Hampton (on-screen)	Elxa's obstetrician, Jamaica Hospital	Apr 20, 1950	55
LaShawn Plummer (new)	Reggie's wife; nurse's aide	Aug 3, 1969	36
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	43
Cedric Hall	Architect; Monty's partner	Jan 22, 1965	41
Dr. Camille Toussaint	Orthopedic Resident	Jul 21, 1976	29
Lillian Divine	Harmony's mother	Feb 14, 1952	53

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Howard Divine	Harmony's father	Aug 30, 1950	55
Dr. Victor Donohue	Marc's grandfather	May 30, 1933	72
Mercy	The House's pit bull puppy	Sep 30, 2005	0

Also appearing: a construction foreman, FDNY paramedics, NYPD Bomb Squad officers, uniformed police, an OR 2 CABG patient, L&D; nurses, a TV reporter, onlookers, and Reggie and LaShawn's toddler son. On TV: Aretha Franklin and Aaron Neville (national anthem, Super Bowl XL). Mentioned: Dr. Okoye (a resident with the flu), Imani Burrell (turning 8), Danita's 4-year-old daughter, Alphonse (Widener Library).

COLD OPEN

1 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - MARC'S ROOM - PRE-DAWN
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - SUPER BOWL SUNDAY - 5:31 AM

Darkness. Marc (27) lies in bed, wide awake, staring at the ceiling. Mercy, now a gangly four-month-old, sleeps across his feet in Biscuit's red collar. He hasn't moved in an hour.

MARC (V.O.)
Sometimes you wake up and you just know.

He sits up slowly. He looks at the window. Gray light is coming up over Manhattan. Cold rain streaks the glass.

MARC (V.O.)
Not a thought. Not a dream. (beat) Something older than that, in the part of your body that was here before you learned to talk.

He puts both feet on the floor. Mercy lifts her head and whines softly, as if she feels it too.

MARC (V.O.)
A dog knows when a storm is coming. (beat) A cell knows when it's dying.

He reaches for his phone on the nightstand. He scrolls to "MAMA." His thumb hovers over it. He doesn't press it.

MARC (V.O.)
And this morning, every cell in my body woke up with the same message.

MARC
(barely, to the empty room)
Not today.

MARC (V.O.)
Today is the day something goes wrong.

2 INT. ELXA AND RUSSELL'S HOUSE - ST. ALBANS - BEDROOM - PRE-DAWN

SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 5:44 AM

Elxa (28), thirty-nine weeks and two days pregnant, sits on the edge of the bed in the dark with both hands pressed against her lower back, breathing slowly. Russell (30) sleeps beside her, snoring softly, a Steelers T-shirt on.

The contraction passes. She checks her watch. 5:44. She gets up, waddles to the dresser and starts putting on maternity scrubs.

RUSSELL
(waking, groggy)
What are you doing?

ELXA
(beat)
Dr. Okoye's got the flu. (beat) Somebody has to run the board from seven to one.

RUSSELL
(sitting up)
It's Sunday. (beat) It's the Super Bowl. (beat) You're thirty-nine weeks.

ELXA
(pulling on the scrub top)
I'm thirty-nine weeks and two days, I'm in prodromal labor, and I'm going to sit in a chair for six hours. (beat) You drop me off. (beat) You go home. (beat) You watch the pregame. (beat) You pick me up at one. (beat) We watch the game together on the couch like normal people.

RUSSELL
(beat)
And if he comes?

ELXA
(beat, deadpan)
Then he'll be born in the best hospital in Queens. (beat) I'll be sitting right on top of it.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

3 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - MORNING
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:14 AM

The kitchen. A Terrible Towel is draped over a chair. Amond (26) wears a Seahawks cap ironically. Harmony (26) packs a cooler with wings and seven-layer dip for tonight. Raven (26) drinks coffee. Marc stands at the window with his coffee, not drinking it.

HARMONY
(beat)
Monty's. (beat) Kickoff's at six twenty-eight. (beat) Aretha's singing the anthem with Aaron Neville. (beat) Then the Rolling Stones at halftime. (beat) Camille says she's rooting for Seattle because Pittsburgh "has enough."

AMOND
(beat)
I'm rooting for Seattle because everybody else is rooting for Pittsburgh.

RAVEN
(beat)
Dash says he's rooting for the commercials.

Marc doesn't respond. Harmony looks up.

HARMONY
(beat)
Marc?

MARC
(still at the window)
Hmm?

HARMONY
(beat)
You okay?

MARC
(beat)
I woke up at four-thirty. (beat) I had a feeling.

AMOND
(beat)
What kind of feeling?

MARC
(beat, turning)
The kind where you know something bad is going to happen today. (beat) And you can't do anything about it.

A silence. Amond sets down his coffee.

AMOND
(dry)
That's called being an intern on a Sunday.

MARC
(beat, almost smiling)
Yeah. (beat) Probably.

4 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - NURSES' STATION - MORNING
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 7:02 AM

A quiet Sunday-morning skeleton crew. Elxa sits behind the desk on her purple cushion, a hand on her belly, with the board and three phones. The interns gather: Marc, Raven, Harmony, Amond, Arianna (26), Esther (26) and Kennerly (27). Kendra Wallace (25), back after the strike, is at the station.

ELXA
(reading off)
Super Bowl Sunday. (beat) In about eleven hours, every man in Queens is going to fall off a ladder, fry a turkey or punch his brother-in-law. (beat) Until then, it's quiet. (beat) Keep it quiet.

ELXA
(beat)
Bullock, Cummings: ER, with Lowery. (beat) Divine: L&D, Dr. Hartwell. (beat) Ellison: CVICU. (beat) Baker: Dr. Robert Bullock has a CABG in OR 2 at nine. (beat) Smilley: Neuro, Graves is on call from home. (beat) Kennerly: floor.

She winces, presses a hand into the side of her belly and checks her watch.

HARMONY
(quietly)
How far apart?

ELXA
(beat, not looking up)
Seven minutes. (beat) It's prodromal, Divine. (beat) It's been prodromal for a week.

HARMONY
(beat)
Your hand's shaking.

ELXA
(beat, setting the pen down)
My hand is not shaking. (beat) Go to L&D.

5 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 5 - MORNING
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 7:24 AM

Dash (34), on day 86, sits up with the Panthers blanket on the left side. A small TV on a swing arm shows the ESPN pregame. Glenda (58) knits. Raven comes in with his morning meds and a sleeve of saltines.

DASH
(beat)
Crackers first. (beat) You remembered.

RAVEN
(beat)
Yvette would kill me.

DASH
(beat, studying her face)
You look like you didn't sleep.

RAVEN
(beat)
Marc woke up the whole house at four-thirty pacing. (beat) He says he has a feeling.

GLENDA
(not looking up from her knitting)
My mother used to get those. (beat) She'd say, "Somebody's walking over my grave." (beat) Then she'd go stand in the kitchen and make biscuits until it passed.

DASH
(beat)
Did it pass?

GLENDA
(beat)
Usually. (beat) Once it didn't. (beat) The morning my husband went to work at the Philip Morris plant.

A silence. Raven looks at Glenda. Glenda keeps knitting.

GLENDA
(beat)
Tell your friend to stay close to people today, baby. (beat) That's all you can do with a feeling.

6 EXT. QUEENS WEST CONSTRUCTION SITE - LONG ISLAND CITY - DAY

SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 9:41 AM

A muddy excavation pit by the East River, in the shadow of half-built residential towers. Cold rain. An overtime Sunday crew pours footings to beat a deadline. REGINALD "REGGIE" PLUMMER (38), an excavator operator in a hard hat and a Steelers hoodie under his safety vest, works the bucket into old landfill: rubble, rotted timber, rust.

The bucket scrapes against something metal. A dull clank. Reggie frowns, climbs down from the cab and walks over to look. A rusted, finger-thick cylinder, a foot long, sticks out of the mud.

FOREMAN
(calling from the edge of the pit)
Reggie! What is it?

REGGIE
(crouching, peering)
Pipe, I think. (beat) Old gas line, maybe. (beat) Hold on.

He reaches down to pull it free. A sharp crack, a flash, a puff of smoke. Reggie is thrown backward into the mud. He lies there screaming. The rusted cylinder is gone.

FOREMAN
(running)
Reggie! (beat) Somebody call 911!

7 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - TRIAGE 1 - MORNING
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 9:58 AM

Harmony checks a fetal monitor on a routine patient. Clayton (34) reviews a chart. Elxa waddles in from the hallway, one hand on the wall, the other on her belly. She looks annoyed.

ELXA
(beat)
Hartwell. (beat) Check me.

CLAYTON
(beat, looking up)
Excuse me?

ELXA
(beat, lowering herself onto the triage bed)
Dr. Hampton's at Jamaica Hospital, and it's Sunday. (beat) Five minutes apart for an hour. (beat) Lasting a minute. (beat) I need to know if I'm going home to watch the Super Bowl or if I'm having a baby. (beat) Check me.

Clayton pulls on a glove. Harmony quietly closes the curtain. A beat.

CLAYTON
(beat, very calmly)
Four centimeters. (beat) Eighty percent effaced. (beat) Zero station. (beat) Congratulations, Dr. Bullock. (beat) You're in labor.

Elxa stares at the ceiling.

ELXA
(beat)
No.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Yes.

ELXA
(beat)
Russell's home. (beat) In St. Albans. (beat) In a Steelers T-shirt. (beat) Eating chips.

HARMONY
(beat, already picking up the phone)
I'll call him.

ELXA
(beat, grabbing her wrist)
Divine. (beat) Tell him to drive carefully. (beat) Tell him I said carefully.

8 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - AMBULANCE BAY - MORNING
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 10:11 AM

Rain. An FDNY ambulance screams into the bay. Lowery (59), Marc and Arianna wait under the overhang. Gloria (53) stands behind them. The doors fly open. On the stretcher: Reggie, pale, screaming through an oxygen mask, a blood-soaked trauma dressing on the left side of his

abdomen.

Kneeling on the stretcher beside him, riding it out of the ambulance, is a young paramedic, DANITA CREWS (27), her braids under a cap, her face white. Her right hand is pressed inside the dressing, inside the wound, up to the wrist.

DANITA
(shaking)
Excavator operator. Thirty-eight. (beat) Something blew up in his hand at a construction site. (beat) Something went into his belly. (beat) Left flank. (beat) I can feel it.

LOWERY
(moving with the stretcher)
Feel what?

DANITA
(beat, terrified)
Metal. (beat) A cylinder. (beat) Rusted. (beat) About this long. (beat) It's got a point on the end. (beat) I put my hand in to stop the bleeding and I touched it, and I... (beat) I can't take my hand out.

They roll into the trauma bay. Gloria cuts Reggie's hoodie off. Marc looks at the paramedic's hand disappearing into the man's side, and the feeling he woke up with closes around his chest like a fist.

LOWERY
(beat)
Why can't you take your hand out?

DANITA
(beat, barely)
Because the foreman said they found World War Two stuff at that site last month. (beat) Shells. (beat) Because I think it's a bomb.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

9 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - TRAUMA 1 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 10:14 AM

Reggie on the trauma bed, intubated now, sedated. Danita kneels on the bed beside him, her right hand still inside the wound. Lowery holds up a portable X-ray against the light. Marc, Arianna and Gloria crowd around. On the film: a bright, tapered cylinder lodged in the left flank, its pointed nose aimed toward the spine. At the tip: a complex metal shape with springs and a firing pin.

LOWERY
(very quietly)
Lord have mercy.

ARIANNA
(staring)
Is that...

LOWERY
(beat)
A thirty-seven millimeter projectile. (beat) My father brought one home from Okinawa as a paperweight. (beat) Mother made him throw it in the Harlem River. (beat) The point is the fuze. (beat) It's supposed to go off when it hits something.

MARC
(beat)
It hit a man.

LOWERY
(beat)
It hit an excavator bucket first. (beat) Then a man. (beat) And part of it went off, and part of it didn't.

Gloria sets down her scissors without a sound. Lowery hands the film to Arianna, very carefully, as if the film

itself could explode.

LOWERY
(calm)
Nurse Pettiford. (beat) Call a Code Black. (beat) Then call the Chief. (beat) Then call the police. (beat) In that order.

GLORIA
(beat, already at the phone)
Yes, Doctor.

Danita looks down at her hand inside the man's body. Tears run down her face.

DANITA
(barely)
Doctor. (beat) What do I do?

LOWERY
(gently, putting a hand on her shoulder)
Ms. Crews. (beat) You don't move.

10 INT. NATASHA AND ROBERT'S BROWNSTONE - RIVERSIDE DRIVE - KITCHEN - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 10:19 AM

Sunday morning. Natasha (47), in a robe, reads the Times at the kitchen island. A coffee. A croissant. Her cell rings. "QGH ER."

NATASHA
(answering)
Donohue. (beat) Gloria. (beat, her face changing) What? (beat) In the patient? (beat) Who's with him? (beat) Lowery and who?

She listens. She stands very slowly.

NATASHA
(beat, barely)
Marc.

GLORIA (V.O.)
(on the phone)
And the paramedic, Dr. Donohue. (beat) Her hand's inside him. (beat) The bomb squad's on their way.

NATASHA
(beat, already moving, grabbing her keys)
I'm coming in. (beat) Isolate OR 1. (beat) That's the farthest from the main wing. (beat) And Gloria, Robert's in OR 2 with a man on bypass. (beat) Tell him. (beat) Tell him before the police do.

11 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 4 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 10:31 AM

Elxa, in a hospital gown, is propped up in a labor bed with a fetal monitor strapped around her belly. She breathes through a contraction. Harmony holds the phone to her ear. Clayton checks the strip.

HARMONY
(into the phone)
Mr. Jeffries? (beat) It's Harmony. (beat) No, she's fine. (beat) She's in labor. (beat) Four centimeters. (beat) Yes, really. (beat) She says drive carefully. (beat) She says, and I'm quoting, "Carefully, Russell."

The overhead speaker crackles. A calm, flat female voice.

OVERHEAD PAGE
(V.O.)
Code Black, Operating Room One. (beat) Code Black, Operating Room One. (beat) All staff, follow Code Black procedures.

Elxa goes absolutely still. Clayton looks up at the speaker.

HARMONY
(beat)
What's a Code Black?

ELXA
(beat, very quietly)
Bomb threat.

CLAYTON
(beat)
It's a drill.

ELXA
(beat)
We drilled in November. (beat) We don't drill on Super Bowl Sunday.

Another contraction takes her. She grips the rail.

ELXA
(through her teeth)
Divine. (beat) Find out who's in OR One.

12 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - CORRIDOR - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 10:43 AM

The ER has been cleared. Security tape across the corridor. Big Ray (46) and two hospital guards hold the line. Through the ambulance entrance comes the NYPD Bomb Squad: four officers in dark-blue tactical gear, carrying cases. At their head, in a raincoat over a shirt and tie, is DETECTIVE SERGEANT ISAAC BURRELL (44), tall, bald, calm as a church deacon.

BURRELL
(to Big Ray, extending a hand)
Sergeant Burrell. (beat) NYPD Bomb Squad. (beat) Who's in charge?

BIG RAY
(beat)
Of the hospital or the bomb?

BURRELL
(beat, a small smile)
Let's start with the bomb.

Lowery comes out of Trauma 1 to meet him, Marc at his shoulder.

LOWERY
(beat)
Dr. Abraham Lowery. (beat) Thirty-seven millimeter projectile, WWII vintage by the look of it, lodged in the left flank of a thirty-eight-year-old man. (beat) The fuze is intact on X-ray. (beat) A paramedic has her hand in the wound, on the shell.

BURRELL
(beat, very calm)
All right. (beat) Here are my rules, Doctor. (beat) No cell phones, no radios, no pagers within a hundred feet of that patient. Radio frequency can set off an old fuze. (beat) No electrocautery. (beat) No defibrillator. (beat) Nobody touches that shell but me or the person already touching it. (beat) We move him to the room farthest from everybody else, and we clear the floors above and around it. (beat) And from now on, nobody comes in or out of this building without my say-so.

MARC
(beat)
You're locking down the hospital.

BURRELL
(beat, looking at him)
I'm locking down the hospital, son. (beat) What's your name?

MARC
(beat)
Bullock.

BURRELL
(beat)
Dr. Bullock. (beat) Is your hand steady?

MARC
(beat)
Yes, sir.

BURRELL
(beat)
Good. (beat) Keep it that way.

13 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 10:59 AM

The farthest operating room in the oldest wing. Reggie on the table, anesthetized. Danita kneels on a padded step stool beside him, her hand still in the wound. DR. EDWIN MABRY (48), Chief of Anesthesiology, dry and unflappable, sits at the head of the bed with an old-fashioned hand-bag ventilator, not the electric one. Lowery and Marc are gowned. Burrell stands in the corner without a mask, watching everything.

MABRY
(dry)
No electricity near the shell, the sergeant says. (beat) So, no ventilator. (beat) I'll bag him by hand. (beat) I've bagged patients through two blackouts and a city strike. (beat) I can bag one through a bomb.

LOWERY
(beat)
Thank you, Edwin.

MABRY
(beat)
Don't thank me, Abraham. (beat) Just be quick.

Burrell crouches beside Danita and looks into the wound without touching anything.

BURRELL
(gently)
Ms. Crews. (beat) How long have you been holding it?

DANITA
(beat, trembling)
An hour and twenty minutes. (beat) Since the pit.

BURRELL
(beat)
Can you feel the point? (beat)
The nose?

DANITA
(beat)
It's against something hard.
(beat) His spine, maybe.

BURRELL
(beat, standing)
Then the nose is wedged. (beat)
That's good. (beat) A wedged
shell doesn't roll. (beat)
Doctor, I'm going to need you to
open him up very slowly, so I can
see what I'm dealing with. (beat)
No metal on metal. (beat) Can you
do that?

LOWERY
(beat)
I've been opening people slowly
since 1974, Sergeant.

BURRELL
(beat)
Then let's begin.

14 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 5 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 11:14 AM

The CVICU is eerily calm. Through the windows, police lights flash blue on the wet street below. On the TV, ESPN's pregame cuts to a breaking-news crawl: "BOMB SQUAD AT QUEENS HOSPITAL; BUILDING LOCKED DOWN." Dash watches. Glenda has stopped knitting. Raven checks his drips.

DASH
(beat)
Raven. (beat) That's us.

RAVEN
(beat, not looking at the TV)
It's in OR One. (beat) The old wing. (beat) Two floors down and a whole building over.

GLENDA
(beat)
Your friend? (beat) The one with the feeling?

Raven stops.

RAVEN
(barely)
He's in the ER this morning. (beat) With Lowery.

Dash reaches out and takes Raven's hand. Glenda reaches over and takes Dash's other hand. The three of them sit in a chain in the CVICU, watching a TV show their own building.

DASH
(beat, quietly)
My father had a saying. (beat) "When you can't do anything, hold on to somebody." (beat) So hold on.

15 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 2 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 11:21 AM

A CABG in progress. The patient is on bypass, his heart still, Coltrane playing from the boom box. Robert sews a vein graft onto a coronary artery. Amond assists. A uniformed NYPD officer in tactical gear stands in the doorway, uncomfortable.

OFFICER
(beat)
Doctor. (beat) The Sergeant's ordered this wing evacuated. (beat) Everybody out.

ROBERT
(not looking up)
Officer, this man's heart is stopped. (beat) A machine is breathing for him and pumping his blood. (beat) If I leave this room, he dies. (beat) I'm not leaving this room.

OFFICER
(beat)
Sir, there's an explosive device two corridors away.

ROBERT
(beat, tying a knot)
Then you'd better go stand two corridors in the other direction. (beat) Dr. Baker, you're free to go.

AMOND
(beat, holding the retractor perfectly still)
No, sir.

Robert glances at Amond over his mask.

ROBERT
(beat)
Amond.

AMOND
(beat)
You need a first assist, sir. (beat) And it's my turn to stay in a room I can't leave.

The officer looks at both of them. He keys his radio, then remembers the rules and lets go of it.

OFFICER
(beat)
I'll tell the Sergeant you're staying.

ROBERT
(beat, back to his graft)
Tell him we'll be quiet. (beat) We'll turn down the Coltrane.

16 INT. RUSSELL'S CAR - QUEENS BOULEVARD - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 11:52 AM

Rain on the windshield. The wipers beat. Russell drives his old Honda Accord west on Queens Boulevard, still in his Steelers T-shirt under a jacket, the hospital bag on the passenger seat. The radio plays WFAN's pregame. His cell phone buzzes in the cup holder. "HARMONY QGH."

RUSSELL
(grabbing it, answering)
Harmony. (beat) I'm on Queens Boulevard. (beat) Fifteen minutes. (beat) What do you mean there's police? (beat) A bomb? (beat) Is Elxa...

He looks at the phone. The light ahead turns yellow. He looks up. It turns red. He brakes. The car stops. Then, from the left, a black livery cab, hydroplaning, runs the red light at forty miles an hour and slams into the driver's side door.

Glass. Metal. The hospital bag flies into the windshield. The phone spins away.

HARMONY (V.O.)
(from the phone on the floor, faint)
Mr. Jeffries? (beat) Mr. Jeffries? (beat) Russell?

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

17 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 4 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 12:09 PM

Elxa's water has broken. The sheets are being changed around her. She's in the middle of a hard contraction. Harmony stands frozen in the corner, staring at the cell phone in her hand. Clayton checks her.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Six centimeters. (beat) Clear fluid. (beat) Baby looks great.

ELXA
(gasping, as it passes)
Where's Russell?

Harmony doesn't answer.

ELXA
(beat)
Divine. (beat) Where is my husband?

HARMONY
(beat, barely)
I was on the phone with him. (beat) On Queens Boulevard. (beat) And then there was a noise. (beat) And then he stopped answering.

A terrible silence. Elxa's face goes slack.

ELXA
(beat)
What kind of noise?

HARMONY
(beat)
Like a car.

The phone on the wall rings. Clayton grabs it.

CLAYTON
(into the phone)
L&D, Hartwell. (beat) Dr. Hampton. (beat) Where are you? (beat) The police won't let you through? (beat) No, she's six. (beat) I know. (beat) I know. (beat) I'll keep you on the phone.

ELXA
(beat, grabbing Clayton's arm)
Call the ER. (beat) Call every ER in Queens. (beat) Find my husband.

18 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - JACKSON AVENUE - POLICE PERIMETER - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 12:26 PM

Yellow tape and blue barricades. Police cars. A crowd of onlookers under umbrellas. TV news vans with satellite dishes. A tall, calm woman in a raincoat with a doctor's bag argues with a young uniformed cop: DR. HAMPTON (55), Elxa's obstetrician. Big Ray stands just inside the tape.

DR. HAMPTON
(firmly)
Officer, I am an obstetrician, and my patient is in active labor on the fourth floor of that building. (beat) She's six centimeters.

COP
(beat)
Ma'am, nobody goes in. (beat) Sergeant's orders.

DR. HAMPTON
(beat)
Then tell the Sergeant that I delivered his sister's twins at Jamaica Hospital in 1994. (beat) Don't look at me like that, young man. (beat) Everybody in Queens has a sister.

Big Ray steps to the tape.

BIG RAY
(beat)
Dr. Hampton. (beat) Ray Toles. QGH Security. (beat) He can't let you in, ma'am. (beat) Not even if you delivered him. (beat) But I'll get a phone to Dr. Hartwell, and you can talk him through it.

DR. HAMPTON
(beat, exasperated)
Twenty-eight years, Raymond. (beat) I've never once delivered a baby by telephone.

BIG RAY
(beat)
Today's a day for firsts, ma'am.

An ambulance siren screams up Jackson Avenue. The cops pull the barricade aside, and the ambulance roars through toward the ER.

19 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - TRAUMA 3 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 12:33 PM

The other end of the ER, outside the bomb perimeter. Paramedics wheel in Russell on a backboard, a cervical collar on, blood in his hair, the Steelers T-shirt soaked red. Esther, Kennerly and Gloria meet him.

PARAMEDIC
(fast)
T-bone on Queens Boulevard. (beat) Driver's side. (beat) GCS fourteen at the scene, now ten. (beat) He kept saying his wife's in labor.

Gloria freezes for a split second when she sees his face.

GLORIA
(beat, barely)
That's Elxa's husband.

Esther looks down at the man. She's met him. Lamaze pamphlets. Oxtails. Mondays.

ESTHER
(beat, very fast)
Russell. (beat) Russell, can you hear me? (beat) Squeeze my hand.

He squeezes weakly with his right hand. His left hand doesn't move.

ESTHER
(shining a penlight)
Right pupil four millimeters and sluggish. (beat) Left-sided weakness. (beat) He's herniating. (beat) Head CT now. (beat) Mannitol. (beat) Intubate. (beat) And get Graves in here.

KENNERLY
(beat)
Graves is at home. (beat) The building's locked down.

ESTHER
(beat, ice)
Then call Sergeant Burrell and tell him a neurosurgeon needs to get through his perimeter. (beat) Tell him the patient is Dr. Bullock's husband. (beat) Tell him the Chief of Surgery's son-in-law. (beat) Tell him anything. (beat) Get Graves in this building.

20 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 12:47 PM

Reggie's abdomen is open. Lowery works slowly and methodically with blunt instruments: no cautery, only clamps, sutures and his fingers. Marc retracts. Danita, white-faced, her arm still inside, rests her other elbow on the table. Mabry squeezes the bag in a steady rhythm. Burrell, now in the jacket and helmet of his bomb suit but with the face shield up, leans in to look.

LOWERY
(calm)
There. (beat) Retroperitoneum. (beat) Left. (beat) Anterior to the psoas. (beat) Lateral to the kidney.

Through the opened tissue, Marc sees it: rusted, olive-drab metal, the size of a cigar tube. Danita's gloved fingers are wrapped around its body. At one end, the blunt base. At the other, buried against the spine, the fuze.

BURRELL
(very quietly)
M54 point-detonating fuze. (beat) Probably from a Navy shipment buried in the landfill when they built the piers in '45. (beat) It's armed. (beat) It fired partway when the bucket hit it. (beat) The booster went. The main charge didn't. (beat) That means the fuze is damaged. (beat) A damaged fuze is the only kind I truly hate. (beat) I don't know what will set it off.

MARC
(beat)
How much explosive?

BURRELL
(beat)
Enough to kill everybody in this room. (beat) Not enough to bring down the building.

MABRY
(dry, still bagging)
Well, that's a comfort.

BURRELL
(beat, to Lowery)
My containment vessel is coming from Rodman's Neck in the Bronx. (beat) Two hours, in this weather. (beat) When it's here, we take it out. (beat) Not before. (beat) Until then, nobody moves.

Danita closes her eyes. Her arm has started to tremble.

21 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 4 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 1:04 PM

Elxa, between contractions, breathing hard. Natasha (47), in a coat thrown over a sweater, rain in her hair, comes through the door. She made it in before the lockdown. She goes straight to her daughter. Harmony steps back.

ELXA
(seeing her face)
Mama. (beat) Where is he?

NATASHA
(sitting on the edge of the bed, taking both her hands)
He's here. (beat) Downstairs. (beat) A cab ran a light on Queens Boulevard. (beat) He has a head injury. (beat) Leland Graves is coming through the perimeter right now. (beat) Esther Smilley's with him.

ELXA
(beat, barely)
How bad?

Natasha doesn't lie to her daughter. She never has.

NATASHA
(beat)
Bad, baby. (beat) A bleed. (beat) He needs surgery. (beat) Leland's the best there is.

Elxa looks at her mother. Then a contraction takes her, harder than any yet. She screams through it and grips Natasha's hands until both of them shake.

ELXA
(as it passes, gasping)
I'm not pushing. (beat) I'm not pushing until I know. (beat) Do you hear me, Mama? (beat) Not until I know he's going to be there.

NATASHA
(beat, quietly)
Elxa, your body doesn't wait.

ELXA
(beat, fierce,
through tears)
Then it can learn.

22 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 5 - NEUROSURGERY - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 1:22 PM

Russell, intubated, his head shaved and pinned. Graves (52), still in the sweater he was wearing at home, scrubbed and gowned in four minutes flat. Esther holds the drill. On the light box, the CT shows a thick crescent of blood over the right side of the brain, pushing it across the midline.

GRAVES
(calm)
Acute subdural. (beat) Midline shift of nine millimeters. (beat) Right frontotemporoparietal craniotomy. (beat) Large. (beat) Dr. Smilley, open. (beat) Fast.

Esther drills. Bone dust. The flap comes up. The dura bulges, dark and tight. Graves opens it. A black, jelly-like clot pushes out under pressure. He suctions. The brain beneath is swollen and bruised.

GRAVES
(beat)
There. (beat) A torn bridging vein. (beat) Bipolar. (beat) Wait. (beat) The sergeant said no cautery near the bomb. (beat) We're in OR 5. Two hundred feet and two firewalls away. (beat) Am I allowed bipolar, Dr. Smilley?

ESTHER
(beat)
Sergeant Burrell cleared this room. (beat) I asked him. (beat) Twice.

GRAVES
(beat, taking the bipolar)
Good. (beat) Then let's save the man so his wife will push.

23 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - JACKSON AVENUE - POLICE PERIMETER - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 1:28 PM

The rain has eased to a drizzle. At the tape, a young woman in a nurse's-aide uniform from another hospital, with a toddler on her hip, pushes to the front: LASHAWN PLUMMER (36). Big Ray sees her face and knows before she says a word.

LASHAWN
(beat, barely)
Reggie Plummer. (beat) My husband. (beat) The construction site called me. (beat) They said something blew up.

BIG RAY
(beat, gently)
Mrs. Plummer. (beat) Ray Toles. Hospital security. (beat) Your husband's alive. (beat) He's in surgery right now.

LASHAWN
(beat)
Is it true? (beat) What the TV is saying? (beat) That it's still inside him?

Big Ray looks at the toddler, a little boy in a Steelers knit cap, sucking on his fingers.

BIG RAY
(beat)
Yes, ma'am. (beat) And the best surgeon in this hospital has his hands on it. (beat) And the bomb squad sergeant is the calmest man I've ever met. (beat) And a young doctor who walks his dog past my desk every morning hasn't let go of it.

LASHAWN
(beat, crying)
He's a Steelers fan. (beat) Reggie. (beat) He was working overtime so he could take today off for the game. (beat) He was going to be home by four.

BIG RAY
(beat, lifting the tape)
Come stand by me, Mrs. Plummer. (beat) Right here. (beat) This is as close as anybody gets today. (beat) You get to be the closest.

24 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 1:36 PM

Monty's is decorated for the Super Bowl with black and gold, Seahawks blue and two big TVs. But nobody is watching the pregame. Every face in the bar is pressed against the front window, looking across the street at the police perimeter and the TV vans. Monty (43) and Cedric (41) stand behind the bar. The door bangs open. Camille (29), in her Saints jacket, soaking wet, out of breath.

CAMILLE
(beat)
Monty. (beat) Is Harmony inside?

MONTY
(beat)
Everybody's inside, baby. (beat) They locked it down at ten forty-five.

CAMILLE
(beat)
I was at Papa's. (beat) In Bed-Stuy. (beat) I saw it on the news. (beat) I drove here. (beat) They won't let me through. (beat) I'm on staff. (beat) I have a badge. (beat) They won't let anybody through.

CEDRIC
(gently)
Sit down, Camille.

CAMILLE
(beat)
I can't sit down.

Monty comes around the bar and puts an arm around her. Through the window, a TV reporter talks to the camera in front of the hospital. On the bar TV behind them, the same reporter, live.

TV REPORTER
(on TV)
...police confirm an unexploded military shell, possibly dating to the Second World War, is lodged inside a patient at Queens Grace Hospital in Long Island City...

CAMILLE
(beat, barely)
Inside a patient.

MONTY
(beat, quietly)
I know who's with him, Camille.
(beat) Ray told me on the phone.
(beat) Lowery. (beat) And Marc.

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 2:11 PM

Four and a half hours. Danita's arm is shaking violently now. Sweat runs down her face under the mask. Her breath comes in short, fast gasps. Marc, across the table, watches her hand inside the wound tremble around the shell.

DANITA
(whispering)
I can't. (beat) I can't feel my fingers. (beat) I can't. (beat) I can't.

BURRELL
(instantly, calm)
Ms. Crews. (beat) Look at me.
(beat) Breathe.

DANITA
(beat, panicking)
My daughter's four. (beat) She's at my mother's in Far Rockaway.
(beat) She's watching the pregame with my mother. (beat) I can't.
(beat) I can't hold it anymore.

Her fingers slip. The shell shifts a millimeter in the wound. Every person in the room stops breathing. Burrell drops into a crouch beside her.

BURRELL
(beat, very quiet)
Ms. Crews, don't let go. (beat)
Somebody's got to take your place before you let go. (beat) Doctor.

Lowery has both hands in the wound, holding back the bowel. Mabry is bagging. There's only one other pair of

hands. Marc looks at the shaking paramedic, at the rusted metal inside the man, at Burrell.

MARC
(beat, steady)
I'll do it.

He slides his gloved right hand into the wound, alongside Danita's. His fingers find the cold, rough metal. He wraps them around the shell's body, one finger at a time, beside hers, then over hers, until his grip has the whole of it.

MARC
(beat, very quietly)
I have it, Danita. (beat) I have it. (beat) Let go.

Danita slides her hand out. It's white, clawed, shaking. She stares at Marc for one second. Then she bolts from the room. The door swings shut behind her.

Marc kneels on the step stool, his hand inside a man's body, wrapped around a live bomb. Lowery looks at him across the table. Burrell looks at him. Mabry keeps bagging.

BURRELL
(beat, quietly)
Dr. Bullock. (beat) Don't move.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

26 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL D - OLD WING - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 2:16 PM

A narrow, dim concrete stairwell in the old wing, just outside the perimeter. Danita sits huddled on the landing in her paramedic uniform, clutching her cramped right hand to her chest, sobbing. The door above opens. Kennerly and Arianna, sent to sweep the floor, come down the stairs and stop.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Hey. (beat) Hey, you're the paramedic.

DANITA
(sobbing)
I left him. (beat) I left that doctor in there. (beat) With his hand on it. (beat) Because I couldn't. (beat) I couldn't.

Kennerly crouches in front of her. He takes her cramped hand very gently and starts to massage the fingers, one at a time, the way you'd work out a cramp after a twelve-hour case.

KENNERLY
(beat, quietly)
You held a live shell inside a man for four and a half hours, Ms. Crews. (beat) In an ambulance. (beat) In an elevator. (beat) In an operating room. (beat) With a four-year-old at home. (beat) You didn't leave him. (beat) You handed him off. (beat) That's what we do.

DANITA
(beat, barely)
What's his name? (beat) The doctor?

ARIANNA
(beat, sitting down on the step beside her)
Bullock. (beat) Marc. (beat) He woke up this morning with a feeling.

27 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 4 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 2:39 PM

Elxa, slick with sweat, rides a contraction, her hands white on the rails, refusing to bear down. Clayton checks her. Natasha stands at the head of the bed. Harmony holds a cup of ice chips. On the wall phone, on speaker, Dr. Hampton's voice from outside the perimeter.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Eight centimeters. (beat) Elxa, he's coming whether you push or not.

ELXA
(gasping)
I said not until I know.

DR. HAMPTON (V.O.)
(on the speaker, calm)
Elxa. (beat) It's Gwen Hampton. (beat) Honey, you can't refuse your cervix.

ELXA
(through her teeth)
Watch me, Gwen.

NATASHA
(beat, low, to Clayton)
How's the baby?

CLAYTON
(beat, eyes on the strip)
Beautiful. (beat) One forty, good variability. (beat) He's patient. (beat) She's not.

Natasha looks at her daughter, then at the door. She hasn't told Elxa where Marc is. She hasn't told anyone in this room. She takes a breath.

NATASHA
(beat, steady)
I need to step out for a few minutes, baby. (beat) Harmony's with you. (beat) Clayton's with you. (beat) Gwen's on the phone. (beat) I'll be right back.

ELXA
(beat, grabbing her sleeve)
Mama. (beat) Where are you going?

Natasha kisses her daughter's forehead.

NATASHA
(beat)
To check on your brother.

28 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 2 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 2:58 PM

The CABG patient is off bypass, his heart beating again. Robert closes the sternum with wires. Amond holds the retractor. The Coltrane is barely audible. Robert's hands are steady, but his eyes keep going to the door.

ROBERT
(beat, very quietly)
Amond. (beat) Which intern is in OR One?

Amond keeps his eyes on the wires.

AMOND
(beat)
Sir, the officer said...

ROBERT
(beat)
Which intern, Dr. Baker?

A long beat.

AMOND
(beat, barely)
Marc. (beat) With Lowery. (beat) Big Ray told the circulator at noon. (beat) I didn't want to tell you with your hands in a chest.

Robert's needle driver stops. For one second. Then it continues. He twists the next wire with absolute precision.

ROBERT
(beat, his voice perfectly level)
Thank you for waiting. (beat) Close the skin, Dr. Baker. (beat) I'll be in the hallway.

29 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 5 - NEUROSURGERY - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 3:07 PM

Russell's craniotomy. The clot is gone. The brain, though swollen, has started to pulse again. Graves has decided to leave the bone flap off to give the brain room to swell. Esther is closing the scalp over a drain.

GRAVES
(beat)
We'll keep the bone flap in the freezer. (beat) Put it back in six weeks when the swelling's down. (beat) Intracranial pressure monitor. (beat) ICU.

ESTHER
(beat)
Will he wake up?

GRAVES
(beat, honestly)
I think so. (beat) Young. Healthy. (beat) We got there in time. (beat) Thanks to you. (beat) Ninety minutes from the cab to my knife, Dr. Smilley. Through a bomb squad perimeter. (beat) Somebody told a police sergeant to get out of my way.

ESTHER
(beat)
I told him who the patient was married to.

GRAVES
(beat, a ghost of a smile)
Go tell her, Dr. Smilley. (beat) She's been refusing to push for three hours. (beat) Go tell her she can.

30 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 3:22 PM

Five and a half hours. Marc kneels on the step stool, his right hand inside Reggie's body, perfectly still. Lowery has packed the wound around his wrist with gauze to brace it. Mabry bags by hand. Burrell sits on a stool across the table from Marc, his bomb helmet on the floor beside him, talking to him in a low, steady voice to keep him calm.

BURRELL
(beat)
Marine Corps. (beat) EOD. (beat) Desert Storm, '91. (beat) I pulled a Russian mine out of a sand berm outside Kuwait City with my bare hands because the robot broke. (beat) I was twenty-nine. (beat) My hands didn't stop shaking for a week.

MARC
(beat)
Mine aren't shaking.

BURRELL
(beat)
I can see that, Doctor. (beat) That's what worries me.

MARC
(beat)
Why?

BURRELL
(beat)
Because the ones whose hands don't shake have usually already decided something. (beat) What did you decide, Dr. Bullock?

Marc is quiet for a long beat.

MARC
(beat)
I woke up at four-thirty this morning knowing something bad was going to happen today. (beat) I've been waiting for it all day. (beat) And now it's in my hand. (beat) It's almost a relief.

BURRELL
(beat, gently)
A relief.

MARC
(beat)
It's here. (beat) I know where it is. (beat) I can hold it.

Burrell looks at the young doctor for a long moment.

BURRELL
(beat)
My daughter's turning eight on Tuesday. (beat) Imani. (beat) She wants a Sidekick phone. (beat) Pink. (beat) Her mother says no. (beat) I'm going to say yes. (beat) That's my relief, Dr. Bullock. (beat) Tuesday. (beat) Find yourself a Tuesday.

31 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OLD WING - CORRIDOR - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 3:39 PM

The long, empty corridor of the old wing, lit by flickering fluorescent tubes. Robert stands against the wall at the edge of the police line, staring at the double doors at the far end. Amond, still in his OR cap, comes up and stands beside him without a word.

ROBERT
(beat, not looking at him)
You closed?

AMOND
(beat)
Skin's closed. (beat) He's in CVICU. (beat) Ellison has him.

A long silence. Somewhere in the building, a phone rings and rings and nobody answers it.

ROBERT
(beat, very quietly)
He used to sleep on my chest. (beat) When he was a baby. (beat) His mother was studying for her boards, so I'd lie on the couch in the Cambridge apartment and put him on my chest and watch the late news with the sound off. (beat) He'd sleep for three hours. (beat) He never moved. (beat) Even then, he never moved.

Amond doesn't answer. He just stays.

AMOND
(beat, finally)
Sir. (beat) He's my day one. (beat) That's what he calls me. (beat) I never told him what he is to me. (beat) I'm going to tell him tonight. (beat) When he comes out.

ROBERT
(beat, turning to look at him)
When.

AMOND
(beat)
When, Dr. Bullock.

32 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - SCRUB ROOM - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 3:46 PM

The small room outside the OR, with a long steel sink and a window into the operating room. A police officer stands at the door. Natasha comes down the corridor fast, still in her coat. Robert is a few steps behind her, in scrubs. The officer steps in front of them.

OFFICER
(beat)
Ma'am. Sir. (beat) Nobody past this point.

NATASHA
(beat)
I'm the Chief of Surgery.

OFFICER
(beat)
Yes, ma'am. (beat) Nobody past this point.

Natasha stops. Robert stops beside her. Through the small square window in the scrub-room door, they can see into OR 1: Lowery, Mabry, the sergeant on his stool, and their son, kneeling on a step stool with his arm buried in a man up to the wrist, his face calm and very far away.

Natasha puts her hand flat on the glass. Robert stands behind her and puts both of his hands on her shoulders.

NATASHA
(barely)
He was born on the steps of Widener Library, Robert. (beat) I never told you that. (beat) A security guard caught him. (beat) Alphonse. (beat) He was in such a hurry to get here.

ROBERT
(beat, his voice breaking)
Tasha.

NATASHA
(beat, not taking her hand off the glass)
He's not in a hurry now. (beat) Look at him. (beat) He's perfectly still.

Inside, as if he feels it, Marc turns his head and looks at the window. He sees his mother's hand on the glass and his father behind her. He doesn't move his arm. He just looks at them. Then he nods once.

33 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 4 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 4:07 PM

Elxa, exhausted, mid-contraction, still refusing to push. Harmony mops her forehead. Clayton watches the monitor. The door opens. Esther stands there, still in her surgical cap, a smear of blood on her scrub top.

Elxa sees her and stops breathing.

ESTHER
(beat, steady, from the doorway)
He's out of surgery. (beat) Dr. Graves took out the clot. (beat) He's in the Neuro ICU. (beat) He's alive, Dr. Bullock. (beat) We think he's going to wake up.

Elxa's face collapses. She sobs once, a huge sound, half relief and half pain. Then she grabs the bed rails.

ELXA
(beat, gasping)
Okay. (beat) Okay. (beat) Hartwell. (beat) Now I push.

CLAYTON
(pulling on gloves, smiling)
Now you push.

The overhead speaker crackles. The calm, flat voice.

OVERHEAD PAGE
(V.O.)
Attention. (beat) By order of the NYPD, the fourth floor, west, including Labor and Delivery, is to be evacuated immediately. (beat) Elevators are out of service. (beat) Use the stairwells. (beat) Repeat. Evacuate the fourth floor, west, immediately.

Everyone in the room freezes. Clayton looks up at the speaker. Harmony looks at Elxa.

HARMONY
(beat)
We're directly over the old wing.

ELXA
(beat, in the middle of a contraction)
You've got to be kidding me.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

34 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL C - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 4:31 PM

A concrete stairwell, lit by emergency fixtures. Nurses help two other laboring women down toward the second floor. Clayton has gone ahead to carry a premature baby down to the NICU. Elxa, in a gown and a robe, is halfway down the flight between four and three, one arm over Harmony's shoulders, the other gripping the rail.

ELXA
(stopping, gasping)
Divine. (beat) Divine, stop.

HARMONY
(beat)
We have to keep moving.

ELXA
(beat, sinking onto the step)
I can't. (beat) I can't. (beat) He's right there. (beat) I can feel his head.

Harmony looks down the stairwell. Empty. She looks up. Empty. The nurses are gone. Clayton is gone. The fire door at the bottom of the flight has swung shut and locked behind them. Lockdown.

HARMONY
(beat, barely)
Okay. (beat) Okay. (beat) Let me look.

She kneels on the step below Elxa. She looks. Her face changes.

HARMONY
(beat, very calm suddenly)
Crowning. (beat) Okay. (beat) Okay, Dr. Bullock. (beat) We're going to do this here.

ELXA
(beat, gripping Harmony's shoulder)
Divine. (beat) Have you ever delivered a baby?

HARMONY
(beat)
On a mannequin. (beat) In September. (beat) In the skills lab. (beat) It was named "Noelle."

ELXA
(beat, a hysterical half laugh)
Then you're more qualified than anybody else in this stairwell.

35 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 4:58 PM

Marc, motionless. Lowery has finished dissecting around the shell. Mabry bags. Burrell, in his full bomb suit now except for the helmet, crouches by the table with a small, heavy metal cylinder: a portable explosive containment pot, its lid open.

BURRELL
(calm)
My big vessel's stuck on the Triborough. (beat) Fifty minutes. (beat) But I'm not waiting fifty minutes with a doctor's hand on a damaged fuze. (beat) This pot will hold a thirty-seven millimeter. (beat) Probably.

MABRY
(dry)
"Probably" is my least favorite word in the English language.

BURRELL
(beat)
Mine too, Doc. (beat) Here's how it goes. (beat) Dr. Lowery frees the last tissue. (beat) Dr. Bullock lifts the shell straight up. (beat) No tilting. (beat) Slow as molasses. (beat) He places it in my hands. (beat) I put it in the pot. (beat) I walk it out the east door, down the service corridor, to the loading dock. (beat) Everybody else stays where they are and doesn't breathe.

LOWERY
(beat)
When?

BURRELL
(beat)
When you're ready, Doctor.

Lowery looks at Marc. Marc looks back.

MARC
(beat)
I'm ready.

LOWERY
(beat, gently)
I'm not. (beat) Give me half an hour. (beat) There's a branch of the lumbar artery against the casing. (beat) I'm not tearing it with my fingers in this patient. (beat) Half an hour, son.

36 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NEURO ICU - BED 2 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 5:09 PM

Russell, his head swathed in bandages, an ICP monitor bolt in his skull, intubated and sedated. The numbers on the screen are steady. Esther sits beside him. Graves has gone to call his wife. Esther holds Russell's limp right hand.

ESTHER
(quietly, to the unconscious man)
Mr. Jeffries. (beat) It's Esther Smilley. (beat) You gave me oxtails in November. (beat) I don't think you remember. (beat) Your wife was annoyed about the Lamaze class.

The monitor beeps steadily.

ESTHER
(beat)
She refused to push for three hours, Russell. (beat) For you. (beat) She told the Chief of OB and the Chief of Surgery and her own obstetrician on the phone that her body could wait. (beat) And then I walked in and told her you were alive. (beat) And she said, "Now I push."

Russell's fingers twitch in her hand. Once. Esther stops breathing.

ESTHER
(beat, leaning in)
Russell? (beat) Russell, if you can hear me, squeeze my hand.

A long beat. Then, faint but unmistakable, his fingers close around hers.

ESTHER
(beat, her eyes filling)
Okay. (beat) Okay. (beat) You hold on. (beat) You've got a son coming. (beat) In a stairwell, probably. (beat) Because that's your wife.

37 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 5 - DAY
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 5:21 PM

On the TV, the pregame show; the network cuts to a live shot of the hospital's exterior under police lights. Dash turns it off with the remote. Raven sits beside him. Glenda is praying under her breath in the chair.

DASH
(beat)
Raven. (beat) Make me a promise.

RAVEN
(beat)
What?

DASH
(beat)
When this is over, (beat) when your friend walks out of there, (beat) you come back here, and you watch the game with me. (beat) The whole thing. (beat) The commercials. (beat) The Stones. (beat) You and me and my mama and a bag of Lay's I'm not supposed to have.

Raven looks at him. Then at the dark TV. Then at her own shaking hands.

RAVEN
(beat, barely)
I promise.

DASH
(beat)
Say "when." (beat) Not "if."

RAVEN
(beat)
When he walks out.

GLENDA
(not opening her eyes, still praying)
When.

38 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - JACKSON AVENUE - POLICE PERIMETER - DUSK
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 5:42 PM

The rain has stopped. Dusk. The crowd at the tape has grown. Camille stands at the barricade beside Monty and Cedric. A van pulls up. Howard and Lillian Divine climb out, still in their church clothes, Lillian carrying a foil-covered pan out of pure habit. Lillian sees Camille and goes straight to her.

LILLIAN
(beat)
Baby. (beat) Is Harmony in there?

CAMILLE
(beat, nodding, crying)
L&D was evacuated. (beat) Into the stairwells. (beat) Big Ray says Harmony's with Elxa.

HOWARD
(beat, coughing, looking up at the building)
Then she's where she ought to be.

Lillian sets the pan down on the hood of a police car. She takes Camille's hand on one side and Howard's on the other.

LILLIAN
(beat)
Then we'll stand where we ought to be. (beat) Right here.

A black Mercedes S-Class pulls up at the far end of the block. The rear door opens. Victor Donohue (72) gets out in his overcoat and fedora and walks slowly toward the tape. A cop moves to stop him. Victor doesn't stop. He walks right up to the barricade and puts both of his hands on it.

VICTOR
(quietly, looking up at the building)
My grandson is in there.

39 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL C - DUSK
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 5:56 PM

The emergency lights hum. Elxa is half sitting, half lying across the landing, her back against the wall, Harmony's balled-up white coat under her. Harmony kneels in front of her, her sleeves rolled up, wearing gloves from her pocket. Elxa is pushing, crying, swearing.

HARMONY
(calm, counting)
Seven. Eight. Nine. Ten. (beat) Breathe. (beat) Good. (beat) That was good.

ELXA
(gasping)
Where's Hartwell? (beat) Where is anybody?

HARMONY
(beat)
On the other side of a locked fire door, Dr. Bullock. (beat) It's you and me.

Harmony takes her cell phone out of her pocket with one gloved hand. One bar. She dials.

HARMONY
(into the phone)
Dr. Hampton? (beat) It's Harmony Divine. (beat) I'm in Stairwell C with Dr. Bullock. (beat) She's crowning. (beat) I need you to talk me through it.

DR. HAMPTON (V.O.)
(on the phone, steady, from outside the perimeter)
Harmony. (beat) Honey. (beat) You're going to put the phone on the step where you can hear me. (beat) And you're going to use both hands.

Harmony sets the phone on the concrete step, on speaker. She kneels. She puts both hands where they need to be.

HARMONY
(beat, to Elxa, quietly)
Dr. Bullock. (beat) Next one. (beat) Push.

40 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - DUSK
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:14 PM

Lowery cuts the last strand of tissue holding the shell with a pair of fine scissors. He ties off the lumbar artery branch with silk. He lifts his hands out of the wound slowly.

LOWERY
(very quietly)
It's free.

Marc's hand is wrapped around the rusted body of the shell. It's free in his palm now, held only by him. Burrell rises, in the full bomb suit, and pulls on his helmet. The face shield comes down. He crouches beside Marc with the containment pot in both hands, its lid open.

BURRELL
(through the helmet, muffled, calm)
Dr. Bullock. (beat) On my count. (beat) Straight up. (beat) Slow.

Marc's eyes are fixed on the open wound. Sweat runs down the side of his face under the mask.

MARC
(beat, barely)
Okay.

END OF ACT FIVE

TAG

41 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - VARIOUS - DUSK
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:22 PM

In the CVICU, Dash turns the TV back on. The network is showing the national anthem from Ford Field in Detroit: Aretha Franklin at a white piano, Aaron Neville beside her, sixty-eight thousand people standing in silence. Dash, Glenda and Raven watch with their hands joined.

In the Neuro ICU, Esther sits beside Russell's bed. His eyelids flutter.

Outside the perimeter, Victor stands at the tape with his hands on the barricade. Lillian, Howard, Camille, Monty and Cedric stand beside him. Nobody speaks.

In the scrub room, Natasha's hand is still flat on the glass. Robert is still behind her.

In Stairwell C, Elxa bears down with a scream, and Harmony's hands are steady.

MARC (V.O.)
Sometimes you wake up and you just know.

In OR 1, Marc's fingers tighten around the shell.

BURRELL
(through the helmet)
Three. (beat) Two.

MARC (V.O.)
Today is the day something goes wrong.

BURRELL
(beat)
One.

Marc begins to lift his hand out of the wound.

CUT TO BLACK.

TO BE CONTINUED

Media Companion: Episode 2x16

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

WCBS-TV / NY1 (breaking news crawl)

Sunday, February 5, 2006, 11:05 AM

"BOMB SQUAD AT QUEENS HOSPITAL. NYPD has locked down Queens Grace Hospital in Long Island City after a construction worker was brought in with what police describe as a 'live military projectile' lodged in his body. The device was apparently unearthed at a Queens West construction site." (A fictional event.)

THE NEW YORK TIMES (Sports): "STEELERS AND SEAHAWKS MEET IN DETROIT"

Sunday, February 5, 2006

"DETROIT -- Super Bowl XL kicks off tonight at 6:28 p.m. at Ford Field... Aretha Franklin, a Detroit native, will sing the national anthem with Aaron Neville, and the Rolling Stones will perform at halftime."

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Sunday, February 5, 2006, 2:44 PM

"WE ARE INSIDE AND WE ARE OKAY. This blog's author is in the building. We can't tell you where. We can tell you there is something in OR 1 that the NYPD won't say on the radio, and that every cell phone on the old wing has been turned off. L&D; is evacuating into the stairwells. A doctor's husband came in from a car crash. Pray. That's all. Just pray." Comments (4,410).

Police radio log (excerpt, paraphrased), NYPD Bomb Squad

Sunday, February 5, 2006

"10:41: units on scene. 10:49: radio silence within 100 feet, OR 1. 11:02: containment vessel requested from Rodman's Neck. 4:24 PM: evacuate 4th floor west. 4:57 PM: vessel delayed at the Triborough; portable pot authorized."

Text message, Harmony Divine to Camille Toussaint (sent 4:33 PM, delivered 5:51 PM)

Sunday, February 5, 2006

Harmony: "stairwell C w elxa. shes crowning. pray for me choir"

Continuity Sheet: Episode 2x16 (Part One)

New Canon Established

- **THE CODE BLACK** (counterpart of Grey's 2x16 and 2x17): at 9:41 AM, excavator operator **Reggie Plummer** (38) at a Queens West site on the East River hit buried WWII-era ordnance (believed to be a Navy shipment dumped as landfill when the piers were built in 1945). A **37mm high-explosive projectile with an M54 point-detonating fuze** partially detonated (the booster fired, the main charge did not) and lodged in his left flank, anterior to the psoas, against the spine. **FDNY paramedic Danita Crews** (27) rode in with her hand on the shell. Lowery called the Code Black. **NYPD Bomb Squad Det. Sgt. Isaac Burrell** (44, ex-Marine EOD, Desert Storm) ordered no radios or phones within 100 feet, no cautery, no defibrillator, OR 1 (the old wing) isolated, and **the hospital locked down** (10:45 AM).
- **MARC TOOK THE SHELL** at 2:11 PM when Danita's hand gave out after 4.5 hours. She ran, and Kennerly and Arianna found her in Stairwell D. Mabry bagged the patient by hand (no electric ventilator). Lowery dissected with blunt instruments and silk, tying off a lumbar artery branch. The containment vessel from Rodman's Neck was stuck on the Triborough, so Burrell authorized a portable pot. **Cliffhanger at 6:22 PM: '...One.' Marc begins to lift.** Marc woke at 4:30 AM certain 'something goes wrong today.' Burrell's daughter Imani turns 8 on Tuesday and wants a pink Sidekick. 'Find yourself a Tuesday.'
- **ELXA IN LABOR** (39w2d): she came in to run the board 7-1 (Dr. Okoye had the flu). Clayton found her at 4 cm at 9:58 AM, her water broke at about noon, and she was at 6 cm at 12:09 PM and 8 cm at 2:39 PM. **Dr. Hampton was stopped at the perimeter**, per MA-005 ('or try to'), and coached by phone. **Elxa refused to push until she knew Russell was alive.** At 4:24 PM the NYPD ordered 4th floor west (L&D;, above the old wing) evacuated by stairwell, with elevators down. **Elxa and Harmony are alone in Stairwell C** behind a lockdown-locked fire door; Elxa is crowning, Dr. Hampton is on speaker, and Harmony is delivering (her only prior delivery was 'Noelle,' a skills-lab mannequin, in September).
- **RUSSELL'S CRASH:** a livery cab hydroplaned through a red light at about 40 mph on Queens Boulevard at 11:52 AM and hit the driver's side (Harmony was on the phone with him). He had an acute right subdural hematoma with 9 mm shift and was herniating (GCS 10). **Esther got Graves through the perimeter** ('Tell him the patient is the Chief of Surgery's son-in-law'). Graves did a craniotomy with Esther in OR 5, the bone flap is banked, and an ICP monitor is in. Esther told Elxa at 4:07 PM. **Russell squeezed Esther's hand at 5:09 PM.**
- **Robert and Amond stayed in OR 2** to finish a CABG on bypass despite the evacuation order ('my turn to stay in a room I can't leave'). Amond told Robert that Marc was in OR 1 only after the patient was off pump. **Natasha told Robert about Widener Library and Alphonse**; now Robert and Elxa know. Natasha and Robert watched Marc through the scrub-room window, and Marc nodded to them. Robert remembered Marc sleeping on his chest as a baby. Amond: 'He's my day one... I'm going to tell him tonight.'
- **Outside the perimeter:** Camille (who drove from Augustin's in Bed-Stuy), Monty, Cedric, Lillian, Howard, Big Ray, LaShawn Plummer and her toddler, and **Victor Donohue**, who walked past a cop to put his hands on the barricade: 'My grandson is in there.' In CVICU, Raven promised Dash they would watch the game 'when' Marc walks out, and Glenda prayed.

Knowledge Tracker (as of 6:22 PM, February 5, 2006)

Item	Who knows
Marc's hand is on the shell	OR 1, Natasha, Robert, Amond, Big Ray, Monty, Victor (via Ray), Arianna, Kennerly, Danita
Elxa delivering in Stairwell C	Harmony, Elxa, Dr. Hampton (by phone), Camille (by delayed text); Natasha does NOT yet know
Russell responsive	Esther, Graves
Natasha's Widener story	Elxa, Robert
Delphine Ware letter	Unopened (Robert; Natasha has seen it)

Patient Registry (in progress)

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Status at 6:22 PM
Reggie Plummer	10/30/1967 (38)	Penetrating injury, left flank; retained live 37mm HE projectile, damaged M54 fuze	Laparotomy, blunt dissection (Lowery; Bullock holding the shell; Mabry hand-bagging)	Shell free; removal begun
Russell Jeffries	4/3/1975 (30)	Acute right SDH, 9 mm shift, herniating (T-bone MVC)	Decompressive craniotomy, flap banked, ICP bolt (Graves; Smilley)	Neuro ICU; squeezed a hand
Dr. Elxa Bullock	8/29/1977 (28)	Term labor, 39w2d; SROM about noon	Hartwell, then Divine (Hampton by phone)	Crowning in Stairwell C
CABG patient (OR 2)	-	Multivessel CAD	CABG on bypass (R. Bullock; Baker)	Off pump, in CVICU

New Characters

- **Det. Sgt. Isaac Burrell** (b. September 14, 1961), NYPD Bomb Squad, the counterpart of Dylan Young. **Danita Crews** (b. June 26, 1978), FDNY paramedic (counterpart of Hannah Davies), from Far Rockaway, mother of a 4-year-old. **Reggie** (b. October 30, 1967) and **LaShawn Plummer** (b. August 3, 1969).
- **Dr. Edwin Mabry** (Chief of Anesthesiology) and **Dr. Hampton** (first name Gwen, established here) make on-screen appearances (in MA-005).

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- Super Bowl XL (Pittsburgh vs. Seattle) was played February 5, 2006 at Ford Field, Detroit, with a 6:28 PM ET kickoff. Aretha Franklin and Aaron Neville sang the anthem, and the Rolling Stones played at halftime. The NYPD Bomb Squad is based at the Rodman's Neck range in the Bronx and uses total containment vessels. Unexploded WWII-era ordnance is periodically found at U.S. construction and dredging sites. The Queens West ordnance discovery and the Queens Grace lockdown are fictional. The T-Mobile Sidekick was a popular phone in 2006.
- Medicine and EOD: old fuzes can be sensitive to shock, heat and possibly radio frequency, so radios, cautery and defibrillators are excluded. Anesthesia without electrical equipment means manual bag ventilation. An acute subdural with midline shift and a fixed or dilated pupil needs

emergent decompressive craniotomy, often banking the bone flap. In active labor, cervical change and SROM proceed regardless of the mother's wishes. Precipitous delivery in a stairwell is managed by controlling the head, checking for a nuchal cord, and delivering the shoulders with gentle downward and then upward traction.